

Moffatt & Nichol

NEWS

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North Shore Riverfront Park Revitalizes Pittsburgh Neighborhoods

North Shore Riverfront Park, part of a Pennsylvania regional initiative to revitalize Pittsburgh's urban waterfront, successfully achieves the goal of attracting the people of Pittsburgh to their rivers, the Allegheny, Ohio and Monongahela rivers, with a nearly mile-long riverwalk that connects Heinz Stadium (Pittsburgh Steelers Stadium) and PNC Park (Pittsburgh Pirates Stadium) on the north shore of the Allegheny/Ohio River.

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Photos by Dixi Carrillo, courtesy of EDAW, Inc.

Returning to the River : Chattanooga Transforms Downtown Urban Waterfront



As the centerpiece of a 20-year-long revitalization of Chattanooga, Tennessee, the 21st Century Waterfront Plan completes the city's return to the river. A sweeping multi-million dollar vision, developed under the leadership of Chattanooga Mayor Bob Corker and RiverCity Company's Ken Hayes, the plan transforms the downtown riverfront with a combination of development, preservation and enhancement. In Mayor Corker's 2003 State of the City Address he stated, *"There is no greater example of our community's ability to create a vision and make it happen."*

The waterfront plan comprises 129 acres on both sides of the Tennessee River, which bisects the City of Chattanooga and stretches 5.5 miles from Veterans Bridge on the east to Moccasin Bend and M.L. King Boulevard on the west. The plan is designed to reconnect the community to and along the river, honoring the history and beauty of the area as it primes the pump of the metropolitan economy.

Moffatt & Nichol Engineers, as part of a waterfront planning consultant team led by Hargreaves Associates, is providing master planning,

schematic design, permit drawings and design development services for the riverfront portion of Chattanooga's waterfront redevelopment. M&N is completing final design and construction documents, and will provide construction services.

CONSTRUCTION SERVICES OF THE RIVERFRONT COMPONENTS

- Site Demolition, Excavation and Fill
- City Marina Replacement/Reconfiguration Along With New Utilities
- Riverwalk (Both Pile-Supported and On-Grade Construction)
- Riverboat Moorings
- Transient Vessel Moorings
- New City Pier
- Various Terraces and Walkways

Hundreds of Chattanooga residents participated in a series of meetings which culminated in a three-day planning session that identified the "return to the river" theme for the waterfront redevelopment.

The revitalization of Ross's Landing Park is a cornerstone of the overall waterfront master plan, which is divided into six districts. Considered the birthplace of the city, the plan for Ross's Landing Park includes a reconfigured Riverfront Park, allowing for an enlarged and enhanced riverside

park. The expansive area encompasses the Chattanooga Green and the Tennessee River Terraces and will be a functional setting for riverside festivals. An expanded marina will provide much-needed docking facilities to accommodate transient boaters. In addition, water taxis, riverfront cafes, residential units and commercial development will complete the area known as the "front porch" of the city. The centerpieces of this district are the expansion of the Tennessee Aquarium, among the finest aquariums in the world, and expansion of the Hunter Museum of American Art.

Improvements along the riverfront will create a new home for the Southern Belle riverboat. The public marina will be upgraded and all along the riverfront, mooring spaces will accommodate visitors whether they are arriving by small recreational boat, luxury yacht or the Delta Queen riverboat. Along the banks of the river, new development opportunities have been set aside for waterfront restaurants and retail shops and residential development on the downtown side of Riverfront Parkway.

Construction of the waterfront redevelopment has recently begun and completion is scheduled for May 2005. ■



San Pedro Waterfront Redevelopment



Planning and design are underway for the redevelopment and revitalization of the historic San Pedro waterfront which features a proposed 7.5 -mile-long pedestrian promenade, parks, retail and commercial projects from the Vincent Thomas Bridge to the Federal breakwater, running along the main channel of the harbor and adjacent to the heart of downtown San Pedro.

The Port of Los Angeles has hired the design team of Moffatt & Nichol Engineers and EDAW, an international urban planning firm, to create and implement the pedestrian promenade along the San Pedro waterfront. Phase I of the project encompasses a mile-long stretch along the main channel of Los Angeles harbor from the Vincent Thomas Bridge to Fire Station 112 which houses the port's fire boats. Construction on the first phase is set to begin next spring and could take 12 to 18 months to complete initial portions.

The port has undertaken an extensive public outreach program to gain approval of the

redevelopment plan. The design team is working closely with the port, the Port Community Advisory Committee, key stakeholders, community groups and the public to consider potential design concepts for the waterfront promenade and other developments.

The main goal of the project is to provide greater public access to the historic waterfront and enhance the image of the Los Angeles Harbor along with downtown San Pedro's revitalization efforts, according to Jim Faul, P.E., M&N's project manager for the team. Among the proposed improvements outlined in a preliminary draft framework for the redevelopment project are a public promenade, natural habitat, green space and water inlet, and various street realignments.

"The first phase of the pedestrian promenade will serve as a catalyst project, designed to spark interest in further redevelopment opportunities," he explained. "The pedestrian promenade is part of a larger plan for greater public access to the San Pedro waterfront and linkages from the downtown area."

M&N serves as the prime consultant for the planning and design of Phase 1 of the San Pedro Waterfront Promenade project. The firm has had a long working relationship with the Port of Los Angeles, planning and designing a variety of projects including, port infrastructure, marina and container terminals, and has developed significant experience in understanding the port's

operations. The design team of M&N and EDAW bring both technical as well as urban planning expertise to the project.

With a strong overall knowledge of maritime operations, M&N's plans and design for the pedestrian promenade will provide public access to the waterfront without interfering with port activities including security and safety. For example, the team is designing a section of the promenade as a pile-supported walkway along the water's edge across from the World Cruise Terminal.

The port has made a strong commitment to ensure that community groups participate in the redevelopment. The design team held a three-day workshop for the community to express opinions on various options for the first phase of redevelopment. Over 300 people participated with ideas ranging from establishing a visitors center that would explain more about the shipping industry to developing a flexible design with large areas of open space connected by various activities or developments.

Despite numerous plans through the years, revitalization efforts in San Pedro have seen little implementation in the past. However, with the latest proposal being initiated and pushed by Los Angeles Mayor Jim Hahn and his sister, Los Angeles City Councilwoman Janice Hahn - both San Pedro residents - many community leaders are insisting that this time will be different and an actual groundbreaking has been scheduled for early Spring 2004. ■

Communities across the nation are turning their attention to their once-neglected waterfronts. The waterfront development movement stems from quality-of-life priorities and a desire among many people to return to the water.

For several decades cities turned their backs on the water while riverfronts and harbors attracted

American cities are using waterfront redevelopment projects to revitalize urban areas and bolster local economies with new jobs, better housing, improved community amenities and added tourism possibilities. Communities recognize the value of attractive waterfronts and their inherent recreational attributes. Cities with areas along a

others such as milder weather so that people can enjoy the waterfront longer.

For waterfront development to succeed, city government must be prepared to finance infrastructure which may not give a return for several years. This is obviously a tall order in times of fiscal austerity and shrinking government responsibility.

Urban Waterfront Development Becoming National Trend



Crissy Field, Golden Gate National Recreation, San Francisco, California



Channelside District Redevelopment, Tampa, Florida



Downtown Louisville Waterfront Park, Louisville, Kentucky

industrial development. Developers focused inland on downtown areas and on suburban shopping malls so the waterfronts often deteriorated.

But now, people are moving back to the water. They feel a need to see and touch the water. So in recent years, developers have taken abandoned waterfronts and turned them into parks, marinas, commercial and retail facilities and housing developments - places that make their communities more attractive and improve the quality of life.

body of water provide many more opportunities for leisure and recreation. Residents are calling for access and municipal governments are responding.

Many cities are beginning to realize just how dynamic an effect waterfront development can have on a city. An attractive waterfront makes a city more livable and generates tourism dollars. When it comes to developing and redeveloping waterfronts, some cities have advantages over

In the redevelopment and revitalization of waterfronts it is important to recognize their historic roles and the changes that have occurred over time. Today, many waterfronts are assuming a new role as places for recreation and relaxation. It is vital in the planning and design of waterfront facilities to retain the historic value of these projects while enhancing public access to and enjoyment of the waterfront. ■



Moffatt & Nichol Active in International Navigation Association

As waterfront development takes on greater importance, the International Navigation Association (PIANC) - which is playing an ever increasing role in shaping the dynamics of the maritime industry - influences the planning and design of many of these projects.

Founded in 1885 in Brussels, Belgium, PIANC is a worldwide organization of practicing professionals, corporations and government organizations concerned with maritime ports and inland waterways. The association promotes contact and advances, and disseminates information to efficiently manage, develop, sustain and enhance coastal and ocean waterways, marinas, ports and harbors and their infrastructure.

Moffatt & Nichol and its senior managers are active members of PIANC and are part of a team of experts conducting important studies and establishing maritime guidelines worldwide.

Robert Nichol, M&N President, serves as a U.S. Commissioner to PIANC; Richard Dornhelm, M&N Senior Vice President, serves as a U.S. Co-Representative to U.S. PIANC's Recreational Navigation Commission; John Headland, M&N Senior Vice President, serves as a U.S. Representative to one of PIANC's Maritime Navigation Commission's working groups; and Dan Allen, M&N Director of Port Engineering, serves as a U.S. Co-Representative to PIANC's Maritime Navigation Commission.

Dornhelm is currently working on a PIANC study and report establishing international design guidelines for accessible boating facility design. People with disabilities are being attracted to recreational boating in increasing numbers. Recent laws in many countries require that public facilities be made fully accessible to disabled persons, yet the requirements for accessibility can vary between countries. Given the increasing mobility of people with disabilities, there is a need to

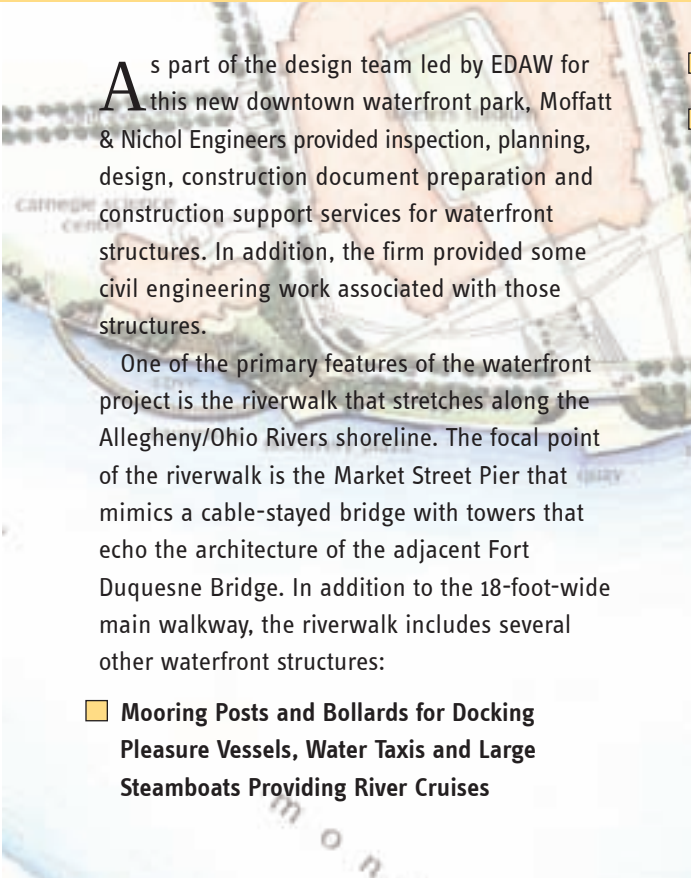
foster a consistent approach so that these people can reasonably expect accommodation when they undertake international travel or as a minimum, have an understanding of the conditions that they may encounter while enroute.

Headland is part of a PIANC committee studying "Minimizing Harbor Siltation." The group will prepare a report about methods to minimize sedimentation in harbors through the use of constructed engineer works, appropriate harbor development and dredged material management. The committee is comprised of 11 members representing nine countries. The report is expected to take two years to complete.

Notably, PIANC established Jack Nichol Award for Outstanding Marina Design in 2002 in memory of the late Jack Nichol, a well-known marina designer and expert in waterfront development and long-time member of PIANC. He served as vice president and was son of M&N founder Frank Nichol. ■



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As part of the design team led by EDAW for this new downtown waterfront park, Moffatt & Nichol Engineers provided inspection, planning, design, construction document preparation and construction support services for waterfront structures. In addition, the firm provided some civil engineering work associated with those structures.

One of the primary features of the waterfront project is the riverwalk that stretches along the Allegheny/Ohio Rivers shoreline. The focal point of the riverwalk is the Market Street Pier that mimics a cable-stayed bridge with towers that echo the architecture of the adjacent Fort Duquesne Bridge. In addition to the 18-foot-wide main walkway, the riverwalk includes several other waterfront structures:

- Mooring Posts and Bollards for Docking Pleasure Vessels, Water Taxis and Large Steamboats Providing River Cruises

- Scenic Overlook
- Riverfront Landings for Passenger Ferries and Amphibious Passenger Vehicles at PNC Park and Heinz Field

The waterfront park is well connected to Pittsburgh's central business district and the adjacent North Side neighborhoods. On foot, pedestrians may access the park from downtown by using any of a series of bridges. Riverboats use water landings in the park to drop-off and pick-up passengers. The park also provides bicycle paths.

In the past, Pittsburgh used its waterways for industry and transportation. As the city's economy moved from manufacturing to technology, education and healthcare, people's perception of the rivers



also began to shift and the desire to reclaim the waterways is being realized. North Shore Riverfront Park is one of the first sections of the city's three rivers park system to be completed.

"North Shore Riverfront Park is truly a front yard for local neighborhoods in Pittsburgh," said Brad Woodall, project manager in M&N's Raleigh, North Carolina office that worked on the project. *"North Shore Riverfront Park is a key component of Pittsburgh's resurgence as a destination city and serves as a model for other city's considering the value of investing in public space."*

Project phases 1 and 1A have been constructed and involved a half-mile of waterfront between the two stadiums and immediately upriver of PNC Park. Phase 2 involves another quarter-mile from Heinz Stadium down river to the Carnegie Science Center. Phase 2 includes a scenic causeway curving into the Ohio River and another scenic overlook. ■

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